

Yuanyuan Hu

PhD Student, Cognitive Neuroscience

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RESEARCH PROFILE

I study how genetic and environmental influences shape brain networks and self-regulatory behavior, with a focus on procrastination, impulsivity, decision-making, and transdiagnostic mental-health risk. My work combines twin designs, neuroimaging, computational modeling, representational similarity analysis, and connectome-genetic approaches.

RESEARCH POSITIONING

Recommended primary positioning: Twin neuroimaging, behavioral genetics, and computational psychiatry of self-regulation and mental health.

- Genetically informed neuroimaging of procrastination, impulsivity, and transdiagnostic psychopathology.
- Computational and neurogenetic mechanisms linking decision-making, self-regulation, and mental health.
- AI-augmented psychological measurement and computational psychiatry as an emerging secondary direction.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Cognitive Neuroscience 03/2025 – Present

Institute of Psychology, Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing

Using twin data to investigate the brain mechanisms through which genetic and environmental factors influence mental health.

Supervisor: Prof. Yuan Zhou.

Master of Philosophy, Applied Psychology 09/2022 – 03/2025

Institute of Psychology, Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing

Using computational modelling and experimental psychology to study behavioural decision-making. Supervisor: Prof. Yuan Zhou.

Bachelor of Philosophy, Applied Psychology 09/2018 – 06/2022

Faculty of Psychology, Southwest University, Chongqing

Trained in research on procrastination. Supervisor: Prof. Tingyong Feng.

RESEARCH INTERESTS AND METHODS

Interests: Neuroimaging of psychiatric disorders; Behavioral genetics and twin studies; Behavioral decision-making.

Methods: Proficient in twin-based genetic modeling and heritability analysis. Experienced in neuroimaging and network analysis methods. Well trained in the theoretical frameworks and methodological approaches of clinical research on anxiety and depression.

AWARDS AND HONOURS

2026 Director's Scholarship, Institute of Psychology, Chinese Academy of Sciences (Top 5 institute-wide)

2026 Best Presentation Award (3/500) and Best Academic Communication Award (3/988), First Capital Universities Undergraduate Academic Conference

2025 Outstanding Student (Top 15%) and Outstanding Student Model (Top 1%), University of Chinese Academy of Sciences

2022–2025 Academic Excellence Scholarship, University of Chinese Academy of Sciences

2022 Undergraduate Scholarship, University of Chinese Academy of Sciences

PUBLICATIONS

Lead-author publications

1. **Yuanyuan Hu**, Jie Xiang, Yuening Jin, Qingchen Fan, Changshuo Wang, Yihan Wu, Dang Zheng, Yancheng Tang, Wei Li, Bowen Hu, Tingyong Feng, Yuan Zhou & Zhiyi Chen (2026). Shared neurogenetic substrates of nonplanning impulsivity and procrastination. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(28), e2605127123. [Independent first author] [SCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 10.6]
DOI/article: <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2605127123>
2. **Yuanyuan Hu**#, Yancheng Tang#, Wei Li#, Dang Zheng, Yuening Jin, Qingchen Fan, Jan K Buitelaar, Yuan Zhou & Zhiyi Chen (2026). Shared neurogenetic architecture links adolescent neurodevelopmental deviations to adult psychopathological procrastination. *Molecular Psychiatry*, 1–15. [Co-first author, 3 first authors] [SCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 12.2]
DOI/article: <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41380-025-03423-0>

3. Zhiyi Chen#, Yancheng Tang#, Xuerong Liu, Wei Li#, **Yuanyuan Hu**#, Bowen Hu#, Ting Xu, Rong Zhang, Lei Xia, Jing-Xuan Zhang, Zhibing Xiao, Ji Chen, Zhengzhi Feng, Yuan Zhou, Qinghua He, Jiang Qiu, Xu Lei, Hong Chen, Shaozheng Qin & Tingyong Feng (2024). Edge-centric connectome-genetic markers of bridging factor to comorbidity between depression and anxiety. *Nature Communications*, 15(1), 1–15. [Co-first author, 5 first authors] [SCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 18.9]

DOI/article: <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-024-55008-0>

4. **Yuanyuan Hu**#, Yuening Jin#, Bowen Hu, Tingyong Feng & Yuan Zhou (2024). Computational modeling interpretation underlying elevated risk-taking propensity in the dynamic risky investment process of non-labor income. *Psychology Research and Behavior Management*, 2491–2504. [Co-first author, 2 first authors] [SSCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 4.5]

DOI/article: <https://doi.org/10.2147/PRBM.S462466>

5. **Yuanyuan Hu**#, Jingjie Zhao#, Yuening Jin, Yi Du, Qian Zhao, Shuai Xu, Li Li & Yuan Zhou (2024). The altered resting-state functional connectivity of thalamic subregions in patients with globus pharyngeus. *Brain Imaging and Behavior*, 1–9. [Co-first author, 2 first authors] [SCI · Q2 · 5-year IF 3.1]

DOI/article: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11682-024-00940-4>

Collaborative publications

1. Yuening Jin, Dang Zheng, Ruolei Gu, Qingchen Fan, Martin Dietz, Changshuo Wang, Xinying Li, Jie Chen, **Yuanyuan Hu** & Yuan Zhou (2024). Substantial heritability underlies fairness norm adaptation capability and its neural basis. *Advanced Science*, 2411070. [SCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 16.3]

DOI/article: <https://doi.org/10.1002/advs.202411070>

2. Wei Li, Xue-rong Liu, Qianyu Zhang, Lei Xia, Yanyan Li, Xiaobing Tian, Jie Gong, Jidong Ren, Chang Shen, Yi Wu, Ji Chen, Chuan-Peng Hu, Jing-Xuan Zhang, Ting Xu, **Yuanyuan Hu**, Bowen Hu, Ni Yan, Tingyong Feng, Zhengzhi Feng & Zhiyi Chen (2025). Implementation of primary psychological healthcare policy to address the risk of depression in underprivileged children and adolescents, in the entire lower-middle-economic-status city of China: an observational, multicenter, and single-arm cohort study. *Depression and Anxiety*, 2025(1), 5572365. [SCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 6.3]

DOI/article: <https://doi.org/10.1155/da/5572365>

3. Bowen Hu, Tongxi Yang, **Yuanyuan Hu**, M. Liu, S. Tan, X. Li & Shaozheng Qin (2026). Neurobehavioral Profiles of Inhibitory-Control Stratify Vulnerability and Resilience under Childhood Poverty. *medRxiv*, 2026-04. [Preprint]

DOI/article: <https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.04.18.26350994>